

Programming Historian

Publishing Workflow:
Guidance for editors



PATREON



Programming Historian is administered by ProgHist Ltd, a charity (1195875) and company (12192946) registered in England and Wales.

Warm welcome to *Programming Historian's* Project Team

- Multilingual community
- Collaboration, people with a range of skills and expertise
- [Project Board/Active Lessons](#)
- [Overview of the publishing workflow](#)
- [GitHub Issues on the ph-submissions repository](#)
 - GitHub issues provide a space for communication and collaboration throughout our publishing workflow. We use labels to indicate the lesson's progress.

Sharing responsibilities

- Eight phases
- Publishing Team professional services
- Managing Editors' vision
- Editorial Project Team: Editors guide lessons from the proposal stage towards publication; liaise with contributors; support authors/translators throughout.

0. Proposal

1. Submission

2. Initial Edit

3. Revision 1

4. Open Peer
Review

5. Revision 2

6. Sustainability +
Accessibility

7. Publication



Publishing Workflow

Responsibilities and timeframes

Phase	Who is responsible?	Expected timeframe:
0 Proposal	Managing Editor + their editorial team	14 days for feedback 90 days for full submission
1 Submission	Publishing Team	7 days
2 Initial Edit	Editor	30 days
3 Revision 1	Author/Translator + Editor	30 days
4 Open Peer Review	Reviewers + Editor	60 days
5 Revision 2	Author/Translator + Editor	30 days
6 Sustainability + Accessibility	Publishing Team (+ Copyeditor <i>original lessons only</i>)	21-30 days
7 Publication	Managing Editor + Publishing Team	14 days



In this phase, Managing Editors circulate proposals for feedback within their team. Successful authors/translators are invited to develop their Proposal into a Submission.

Who's responsible?

Managing Editor + Editorial Team

Expected timeframe?

14 days feedback

90 days submission



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- Managing Editors receive proposals through Proposal Forms. (EN, ES, FR, PT)
 - Proposals are circulated for feedback from the editorial team within 14 days.
 - Proposals are considered on the basis of how well they serve the needs of the community, and whether they support our journal's ambitions of **openness, global access, multilingualism** and **sustainability**.
 - Managing Editors reply to authors/translators to either reject the proposal and share feedback, or invite submission.
 - If the proposal is successful, Managing Editors open a new GitHub issue in which the collaborative development of the lesson will take place. They assign an Editor, and agree a submission date within 90 days.
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Our Publishing Team receives and processes Submission packages.

We check and upload the markdown file, figure images, and data assets. We add essential metadata and generate a live preview of the lesson.

Who's responsible?

Publishing Team

Expected timeframe?

7 days

0. Proposal

1. Submission

2. Initial Edit

3. Revision 1

4. Open Peer
Review

5. Revision 2

6. Sustainability +
Accessibility

7. Publication

- 
- Publishing Team receives and processes submission materials.
 - Markdown files are checked, and key elements of metadata are added.
 - Figures are resized and renamed according to our requirements and conventions.
 - Data assets are checked and processed.
 - The Publishing Team will post a comment to the GitHub Issue, providing locations of all key files, as well as a link to a live 'in browser' preview, where contributors will be able to read the lesson as the draft progresses. They will post an additional comment at the beginning of each phase to clarify *What's happening now?*
 - The team may ask the author/translator to provide some initial adjustments to their submission before it can progress to Phase 2.
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[PH] [P̃H] [P̂H] [P_tH]

2 Initial Edit Overview

In this phase, editors read lessons
to provide authors/translators
with initial feedback.

Who's responsible?

Editor

Expected timeframe?

30 days

0. Proposal

1. Submission

2. Initial Edit

3. Revision 1

4. Open Peer
Review

5. Revision 2

6. Sustainability +
Accessibility

7. Publication

- 
- Read the submission, considering how well it meets our journal's ambitions of **openness, global access, multilingualism and sustainability**.
 - Consider the lesson's level of **difficulty** against our [matrix](#).
 - Share your initial feedback as a comment in the GitHub issue, anchoring specific comments to sections or paragraphs (referring to numbers at the right margin of the lesson preview) to support the author's/translator's revisions in Phase 3.
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Resources 1:

Editorial Considerations: What does *Programming Historian* mean by openness, global access, multilingualism and sustainability?

Resources 2:

Difficulty Matrix: How does *Programming Historian* define difficulty?

This phase is an opportunity for authors/translators to revise their draft in response to the editor's initial feedback

Who's responsible?
Author / Translator + Editor

Expected timeframe?
30 days

0. Proposal

1. Submission

2. Initial Edit

3. Revision 1

4. Open Peer Review

5. Revision 2

6. Sustainability + Accessibility

7. Publication

- 
- Agree a timeframe for the author/translator to make the suggested revisions (30 days is usually reasonable).
 - Author/translator revises the lesson.
 - Author/translator posts a comment in the Issue to confirm when the revised draft is ready for your review.
 - Re-read the lesson to confirm if it should be moved onwards to Phase 4.
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- During this phase, begin contacting peer reviewers to participate at Phase 4.
 - Revision is a collaborative process, involving dialogue. The depth of editorial work involved will vary from lesson to lesson.
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- Towards the end of Phase 3, you'll begin looking for two available volunteers to review the lesson.
- We encourage and celebrate diversity of gender, nationality, race, age, and academic background among our contributors. Managing Editors + Publishing Team will advise you who among our current Peer Reviewer volunteers are available, or support you to make direct approaches.

Resources 1:

[Template 1a: Initial Approach](#) and (if needed) [Template 1b: Initial Follow Up](#)
[Finding Peer Reviewers for Technical Tutorials](#) (5:06)
[Approaching Peer Reviewers for Technical Tutorials](#) (9:06)

Resources 2:

[Template 2a: Positive Response](#) or [Template 2b: Negative Response](#)

This phase is an opportunity for authors/translators to receive feedback from peers in the community. Please share the Reviewer Guidelines, and our [Code of Conduct](#).

Who's responsible?

Reviewers, Editor, Ombudspeople

Expected timeframe?

60 days

0. Proposal

1. Submission

2. Initial Edit

3. Revision 1

4. Open Peer
Review

5. Revision 2

6. Sustainability +
Accessibility

7. Publication

- Introduce two peer reviewers from the community who will read the lesson / translation and test the code, by posting a comment to open Phase 4 using template **Opening Comment Phase 4**.
- Email both peer reviewers using **Template 3: Launch Review** to share key links and guidance.
- Reviewers share their feedback as a comment in the issue thread within 60 days.
- Summarise the two reviews so that the author/translator has a clear sense of the revisions to work through in Phase 5.

Resources 1:

[Opening Comment Phase 4](#)

Resources 2:

[Reviewer Email Template 3: Launch Review](#)



Next, authors/translators revise their draft in response to the peer reviewers' feedback.

Who's responsible?
Author/Translator + Editor

Expected timeframe?
30 days



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- Agree a timeframe for the author/translator to make the suggested revisions (30 days is usually reasonable).
 - Ask the author/translator to post a comment in the Issue to confirm when the revised draft is ready for your review.
 - Author/translator revises the lesson.
 - Re-read the lesson to confirm that all agreed revisions are complete.
 - Managing Editor will read the lesson to confirm if it should be moved onwards to Phase 6.
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Our Publishing Team coordinates a series of tasks including: copyediting, typesetting, generating archival links, collating copyright agreements, reviewing essential metadata, and assigning a unique DOI.

Who's responsible?

Publishing Team (+ Copyeditor for *original lessons only*)

Expected timeframe?

21 days



- Copyediting (*original lessons only*) to check the text for clarity of expression, typing mistakes and grammatical errors.
- Typesetting to ensure consistent layout.
- Generating archival hyperlinks.
- Checking of files and metadata.
- Assigning a DOI.
- Collating copyright agreements.

Our Managing Editors read the lesson one more time, to provide final feedback or suggest additional revisions. When the lesson is ready, we create a Pull Request to publish it. We announce new lessons via social media.

Who's responsible?
Managing Editor + Publishing Team

Expected timeframe?
14 days



- Managing Editors re-read the lesson, to provide final feedback or suggest additional revisions.
- Publishing Manager stages files for publication.
- Managing Editor approves the lesson for publication.
- Publishing Team initiates announcement + schedules promotion of the new lesson.
- Publishing Team shares suggested citation + social media announcement links with all contributors to close the Issue.
- Email both peer reviewers using Template 4: Post-publication Thank You.



Anisa Hawes
[Publishing Manager](#)



Charlotte Chevie
[Publishing Assistant](#)

Remember:
We're on hand to help!



<https://programminghistorian.org/>



[@proghist.bsky.social](https://bsky.social/@proghist)



[@ProgHist@hcommons.social](https://hcommons.org/@ProgHist)

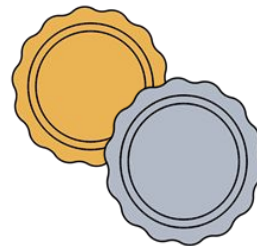


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